

Nicole Arocha

Director of Design Technology

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Design technology leader who's spent 12+ years building the systems, design-to-code pipelines, and AI-powered workflows that let design teams move faster without losing craft. Currently leads an Experience Design team, owns the Figma design system, and has spent the last three quarters piloting AI tooling — including an AI-generated component library prototype, Figma Make, and a test agent for quoting insurance. Also built the customer-measurement infrastructure (Pendo, CES/NPS/CSAT) that ties design decisions to business outcomes. Looking to bring that same combination of systems thinking, hands-on AI experimentation, and cross-functional influence to a design technology practice at scale.

CORE STRENGTHS

Design Systems & Tooling: Figma design systems (variables, components, Dev Mode), component library architecture, Storybook component libraries built and connected to AI prototyping tools, design-to-dev handoff standardization, Angular/front-end collaboration

AI-Assisted Design: Figma Make, Claude Design, Claude Code, AI-generated component library prototyping, LLM-assisted workflows, test-agent building, evaluating and piloting emerging AI design tools

Leadership: Team building & mentorship, capacity planning, job description design, executive-level storytelling, cross-functional influence with Product & Engineering, research process definition, Legal & Compliance department collaboration, outcome tracking

Customer Insight & Measurement: Behavioral analytics (qualitative & quantitative), CES/NPS/CSAT program ownership, journey mapping, persona development, user interviewing

Tools: Figma, Claude, Copilot, ChatGPT, Figma Make, Pendo, Jira, Storybook, Miro/Mural, Illustrator, Photoshop, Microsoft suite

EXPERIENCE

EMPLOYERS (Employer's Insurance Group), Remote — Manager, Experience Design — Product & Digital Operations

NOV 2023 – PRESENT

Nationwide workers' compensation provider

- Lead the Experience Design (XD) team: defined job descriptions and team vision/mission, built the team's first Kanban board for design-work visibility in Jira, and created a capacity-planning roadmap
- Own the Figma design system; standardized the LI Design Brief template and final handoff format used across every initiative, and pushed for the Angular upgrade needed to support a shared component library and ADA compliance
- Piloting AI tooling for the design practice: partnered with Enterprise Architecture on an AI-generated, framework-agnostic first-pass component library; evaluated Figma Make as an AI-assisted design tool; built a test agent for quoting direct business
- Established the company's first Storybook component library and began connecting it to Claude Design as a live component source for AI-assisted prototyping
- Built the organization's first real-time Voice of Customer program — took ownership of the bi-annual CSAT survey, stood up real-time NPS and CES scoring in Pendo, transitioned CSAT ownership from Data Science to Design, and created journey maps and refreshed agent personas
- Led design across the CRM replacement (retiring Oracle CRM, Hubspot, a standalone Five9 app, and manual tracking spreadsheets for Microsoft Dynamics); embedding design from discovery caught critical gaps before launch
- Redesigned agent-facing Endorsements navigation; 86% of surveyed agents preferred the new experience
- Mentor 2 designers and upskilled Claims product managers on interview technique, building sustainable in-house research capacity

BiggerPockets, Remote — Lead UX Designer

SEP 2022 – NOV 2023

Largest online community of real estate investors

- Led Marketplace design strategy; designed a lender-matching system that translated lending complexity into plain language, contributing to 2x revenue growth for the Lender Finder product in its first year
- Owned the design system and set brand and usability standards for design contractors, cutting new-product delivery time by roughly a third and keeping the experience consistent across apps
- Drove executive and delivery-team alignment on Marketplace features using customer data and usability testing

Hopewell Health, Remote — *Lead UX Designer*

MAR 2022 – SEP 2022

Seed-stage startup increasing access to kidney transplants

- Set design strategy for a new product from scratch and ran user research to identify the key blockers patients face receiving transplants
- Designed and tested a patient outreach app to help recruit living donors, and defined the KPIs used to track its success

BiggerPockets, Remote — *Senior/Lead UX Designer*

JUN 2021 – MAR 2022

Largest online community of real estate investors

- Advocated for and stood up a design system and component library to speed delivery and build user trust in the product
- Provided product design support across two agile teams serving investors, agents, and lenders; defined strategy and UI/UX for the BiggerPockets forums re-platform

Pinnacol Assurance, Denver, CO — *Senior UX Designer*

SEP 2019 – MAR 2021

Colorado's leading workers' compensation insurer

- Mentored a junior designer through promotion to senior designer, and mentored design interns on UX/UI fundamentals
- Revamped the customer quote UI, driving a 6% increase in policy conversions

OptioSurgical, Lakewood, CO — *Lead Senior User Experience Designer*

FEB 2019 – AUG 2019

Healthcare startup building a suite of surgery data analytics tools

- Established the component library and design system, defining component states in partnership with engineering to build a Storybook component library

Cake Insure, Denver, CO — *Lead Senior UX Designer*

JUN 2017 – FEB 2019

Startup digital agency for Pinnacol Assurance

- Designed an initial quote app that cut quote time from weeks to five minutes with next-day coverage, winning 3rd place for best mobile app from AASCIF; a later NPS-driven redesign raised NPS by 16 points
- Built a design system supporting theming and rebranding for third parties, letting the front-end team ship 3x faster

DaVita Kidney Care, Denver, CO — *User Experience Product Designer*

NOV 2014 – JUN 2017

Fortune 500 dialysis service provider

- Served as product owner & UX designer for the Falcon Electronic Health Record (EHR) system and designed the Electronic Prescription for Controlled Substances (EPCS) feature and the ICD-10 conversion, both requiring rigorous government certification

EDUCATION

Wharton School — Executive Presence and Influence: Persuasive Leadership Certification

Nielsen Norman Group — UX Design Certification

Rocky Mountain College of Art & Design — BFA, Communication Arts & 3D Animation, Magna Cum Laude